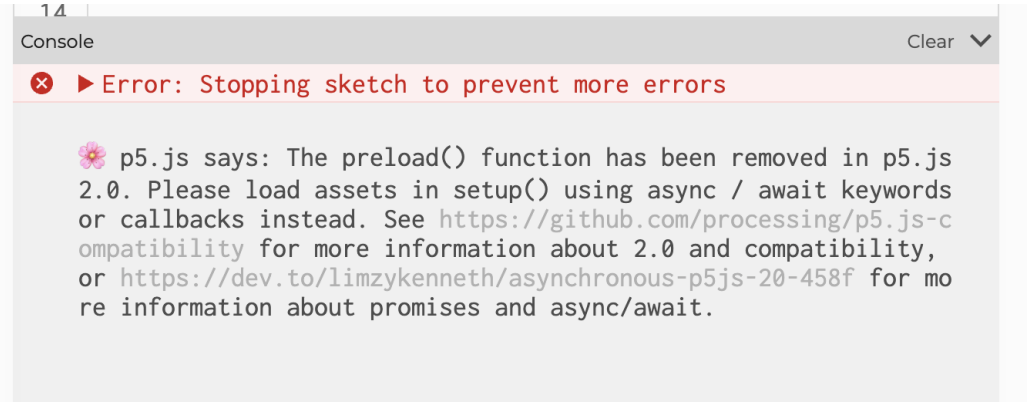
Jellyfish Animation - Problems & Solutions

p5.js homework | Process screenshots and notes

1. The image did not load

Problem: I used **preload()** to load my jellyfish image. p5.js 2.0 showed an error and the sketch stopped.

Solution: I changed it to **async function setup()** and used **await loadImage("jellyfish.png")**. The image then loaded correctly.

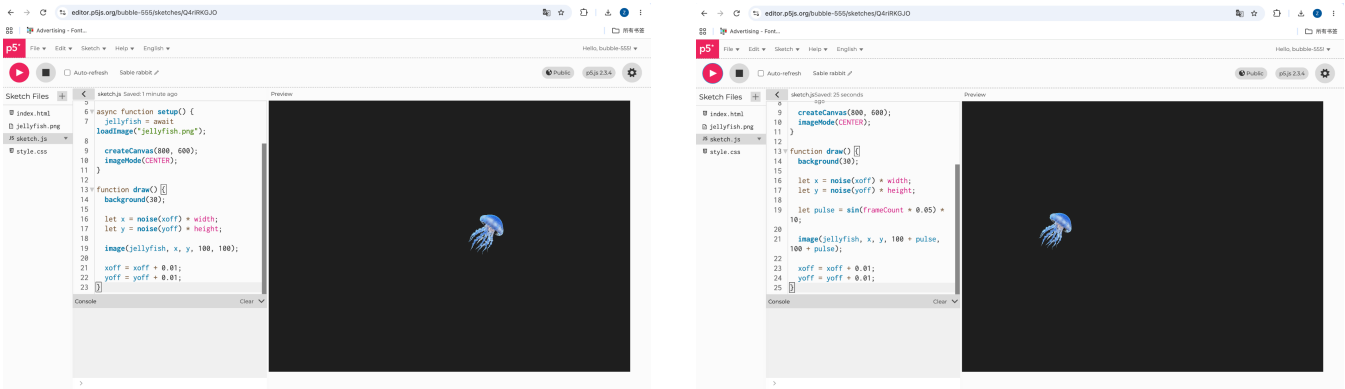


Screenshot: the original **preload()** error in the Console.

2. The jellyfish movement looked unnatural

Problem: I first tried making the jellyfish pulse by changing the image size. It looked like a picture being stretched, especially because my first image was tilted.

Solution: I rotated and centered the source image, kept the scaling more even, and added gentle floating and swaying instead of squeezing the image in different directions.



Process screenshots: basic noise movement (left), then the first pulsing experiment (right).

3. The bubbles moved too straight

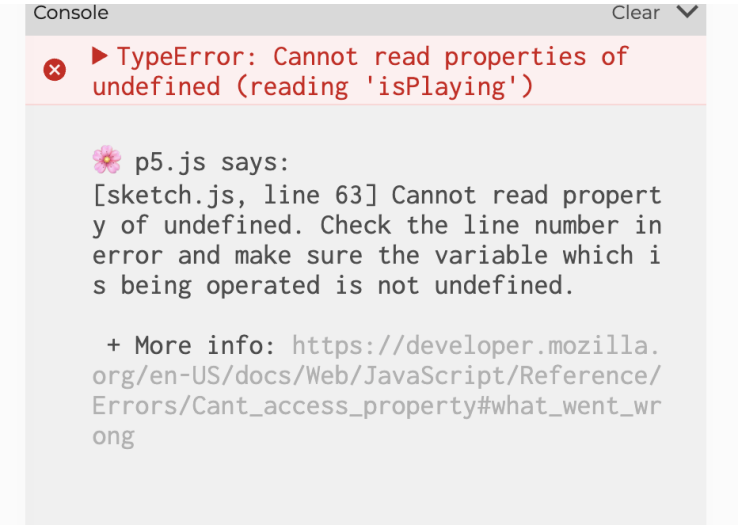
Problem: At first, the bubbles only moved straight upward. They looked too mechanical for an underwater scene.

Solution: I used **random()** to give bubbles different positions, sizes and speeds. I also used **sin()** to make them move a little from side to side.

4. The ocean sound did not play

Problem: The sound did not start correctly. The Console showed an error because **oceanSound** was undefined when the code checked **isPlaying()**.

Solution: I checked the audio file and sound library, loaded the audio using **await loadSound()**, and made the sound loop and play after a click.



Screenshot: the error involving **isPlaying()** and an undefined value.

Reflection: Solving the movement problem

At first, I tried to make the jellyfish look alive by changing its width and height. The code worked, but the movement looked strange. The whole picture seemed to stretch, and the jellyfish was tilted. This made me realize that a simple size change does not always look like a real animal moving. The direction and shape of the original picture also affect the animation.

I solved this by rotating and centering the jellyfish picture. I then used more even scaling and added slow floating and swaying. The result is still based on one image, so it cannot show the tentacles moving separately. However, the movement looks calmer and more natural now. I learned that preparing the image is just as important as writing the movement code.

Final sketch: GitHub Pages - Jellyfish Animation